

Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed + carboplatin

Immunotherapy + chemotherapy for metastatic non-squamous NSCLC

WHAT THIS REGIMEN IS FOR

First-line treatment for metastatic non-squamous non-small cell lung cancer without EGFR or ALK-positive mutations, when this regimen is appropriate.

MEDICINES

Pembrolizumab

Pemetrexed

Carboplatin

TREATMENT JOURNEY

Before cycle 1 Blood tests, kidney function, glucose and thyroid testing; folic acid and vitamin B12 support for pemetrexed.	Cycles 1-4 · day 1 Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed + carboplatin every 21 days.	Between cycles Watch for immune symptoms and chemotherapy effects; they can occur at any time.	After cycle 4 Carboplatin stops if the plan is followed and disease/toxicity allow.	Maintenance Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed every 21 days until progression or unacceptable toxicity, according to the treatment plan.
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REGIMEN-SPECIFIC POINT
Immune-related side effects can begin during treatment or after it stops. Do not wait for the next cycle if a new symptom is worrying.

MONITORING / SUPPORT

- Take folic acid exactly as prescribed while on pemetrexed and for the required period after it stops.
- Vitamin B12 is given before pemetrexed and then at protocol-defined intervals.
- Blood count, kidney/liver profile and glucose are checked before each cycle; thyroid tests are repeated during treatment.

Where changes may show up

Patient-first anatomical guide · report the symptom rather than trying to diagnose the cause

Lungs

New cough or breathlessness can be infection, cancer, a clot or immune pneumonitis. Report it promptly.

Hormones + glucose

Fatigue, dizziness, headache, thirst or passing more urine can signal an immune endocrine problem.

Bowel + liver

New diarrhoea, severe abdominal pain, yellow eyes or dark urine can reflect immune inflammation.

Blood + infection

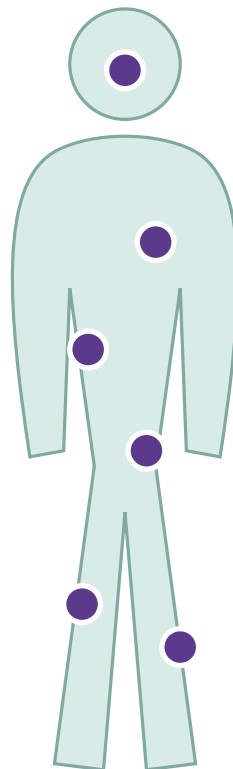
Chemotherapy can lower blood counts. Fever, shivers or sudden illness needs immediate oncology contact.

Kidneys

Pemetrexed depends on kidney function; reduced urine or swelling should be reported.

Skin + nerves

Rash, blistering, weakness, numbness or visual change should be reported, particularly if new or worsening.



WHEN TO CALL

Call oncology urgently for fever, new breathlessness, persistent diarrhoea, jaundice, severe rash, marked weakness, confusion or any rapidly worsening symptom. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain: call 112/999.



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